Registration

The registration is free of cost. Those who want to participate in the seminar are requested to send their short CV with a covering letter to the convener of the seminar **(narayana64@gmail.com).**

Travel and Accommodation

The participants and delegates are advised to make their own arrangements for travel and accommodation. However, accommodation can be arranged in hotels at Karaikudi on prior request and payment.

Programme Committee

Patron	:	**Prof. N. Rajendran** Vice-Chancellor
Co-Patron	:	**Prof. H. Gurumallesh Prabu** Registrar
Convener	:	**Dr. A. Narayanamoorthy** Senior Professor and Head Department of Economics and Rural Development
Organizing Secretaries	:	Dr. R. Suresh Dr. K. Ramesh Kumar Dr. R. Manimohan
Co-organising Secretaries	:	Dr. N. Gayathri Devi Dr. P. Jothi Dr. N. Devika Dr. C. Renuka

Key Speakers of the Seminar

Dr. Cecilia Tortajada, Senior Research Fellow, Institute of Water Policy, National University of Singapore, Singapore.
Dr. Suresh Babu, Senior Research Fellow, International Food Policy Research Institute, USA.
Prof. R. S. Deshpande, Former Director, Institute for Social and Economic Change, Bangalore.
Prof. C. Ramasamy, Former Vice-Chancellor, Tamil Nadu Agricultural University, Coimbatore.
Prof. R. Maria Saleth, Formerly Senior Institutional Economist, International Water Management Institute, Sri Lanka.
Prof. K. Palanisami, Principal Researcher, International Water Management Institute, Colombo, Sri Lanka.
Prof. M. G. Chandrakanth, Director, Institute of Social and Economic Change, Bangalore.
Dr. M. Dinesh Kumar, Director, Institute for Resource Analysis and Policy, Hyderabad.
Dr. R. P. S. Malik, Scientist, International Water Management Institute (IWMI) Colombo, Sri Lanka.
Dr. Chandra Sekhara Rao, Professor, Institute of Economic Growth, New Delhi.
Dr. L. Venkatachalam, RBI Chair Professor, Madras Institute of Development Studies (MIDS), Chennai.
Dr. Nitin Bassi, Principal Researcher, Institute for Resource Analysis and Policy (IRAP), New Delhi.
Dr. S. Narayanan, Vice-President, Jain Irrigation System Ltd, Jalgaon, Maharashtra.
Dr. S. S. Kalamkar, Director, AERC, Sardar Patel University, Gujarat.
Dr. D. Sureshkumar, Professor, CARDS, Tamil Nadu Agricultural University, Coimbatore.
Dr. C. S. Bahinipati, Indian Institute of Technology, Tirupati.

International Seminar on

"Micro-Irrigation in India: Economics, Impact and Potential"

[Organised under RUSA Phase 2.0 Scheme]

January 30-31, 2020

Organised by

Department of Economics and Rural Development

ALAGAPPA UNIVERSITY

[A State University Accredited with A+ Grade by NAAC (CGPA: 3.64) in the Third Cycle and Graded as Category-I University by MHRD-UGC]

Karaikudi - 630 003, Tamil Nadu, India

About the University

Alagappa University, located at Karaikudi, Tamil Nadu, is accessible from Madurai and Tiruchirappalli Airports well within two hours. The 440 acre green and lush campus houses all the academic activities. This University has emerged from the galaxy of institutions initially founded by the great philanthropist and educationist Dr. RM. Alagappa Chettiar. Alagappa University was brought into existence by a Special Act of the Government of Tamil Nadu in May 1985 with the objective of fostering research, development and dissemination of knowledge in various branches of learning. Alagappa University is recognized by the University Grants Commission (UGC) of India. The University has 44 Departments, 9 Centres and 2 Constituent Colleges on its campus. 40 Affiliated Colleges located in the districts of Sivagangai and Ramanathapuram are part of the University which includes one Autonomous College and one Alagappa University Model College of Arts and Science located at Kilakkarai and Paramakudi, respectively. The University offers education through Regular, Distance and Collaborative modes. Through all these modes of education, the University caters to the needs of the student community of around 1.14 lakhs. As a member of the Association of Indian Universities (AIU) as well as the member of the Association of Commonwealth Universities (ACU), it has rewarding relations with other academic institutions, research laboratories and industrial establishments that promise a spectacular future. The University is having International Collaborations with Universities/Institutions of Higher Learning in countries like Japan, China, Malaysia, Singapore, West Indies, U.S.A. and South Korea. Innovative programmes are designed and being offered at the University for the foreign students. The University's motto is "Excellence in Action" and the University keeps before it the vision of excellence in all spheres of its action which earned various distinctions such as (i) Accreditation by National Assessment and Accreditation Council (NAAC) with A+ grade with CGPA of 3.64, (ii) Category-I Institution Status by MHRD-UGC, (iii)Autonomy Status by MHRD-UGC, (iv) NIRF Rank 28 in 2019, and (v) Rashtriya Uchchatar Shiksha Abhiyan (RUSA) Grant. Under the stewardship of the present Vice-Chancellor Dr. N. Rajendran, the Alagappa University is marching ahead to bag many more academic laurels in the years to come.

About the Department

The Department of Economics and Rural Development is one of the well-known Departments in South India in terms of publication of research papers in well recognised journals, carrying out research projects, involving in policy level committees, etc. It was established during the year 2011 (formerly it was known as Centre for Rural Development that was established during the year 2005). The Department currently offers programmes such as M.A., M.Phil., and Ph.D. Within the short span of its establishment, the Department has made many landmark achievements in academic spheres. The faculty members of the Department have completed several research projects on various themes sponsored by the national and international agencies such as the Ministry of Agriculture (Government of India), Planning Commission (Government of India), the National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development (NABARD), Indian Council for Social Science Research (ICSSR, New Delhi), International Water Management Institute (Colombo, Sri Lanka) and International Crops Research Institute for Semi-Arid Tropics (ICRISAT). So far, it has completed over one crore rupees worth of projects. The core research competency of the Department is that it has proven record in carrying out empirical works in the areas of irrigation water including micro-irrigation, watershed development, benefit-cost analysis of agricultural projects, agriculture and rural economics. With large number of papers in well recognised national and international journals, including the world's top 20 Agricultural Economics journals rated by the Google Scholar, some faculty members in the Department have very high level 'h' index of 26, which is seldom seen in Social Sciences and Economics in particular.

About the Seminar

The demand for water for different uses in India has been increasing, but the potential water available for future use is declining at a faster rate. Agriculture (irrigation) continues to be the major water consuming sector due to the intensification of cultivation. The predominant practice of irrigation in India is flood (conventional) method of irrigation which is resulted in poor water use efficiency. One of the demand management strategies introduced recently to control the water consumption in Indian agriculture is drip method of irrigation (DMI). Unlike flood method of irrigation, drip method supplies water directly to the root zone of the crop through a network of pipes with the help of emitters. Although DMI technology is introduced primarily to increase the water use efficiency in agriculture, it also delivers several benefits such as reduction in water consumption and cost of cultivation, enhancement of productivity and profitability. The reduction in water consumption in drip irrigation also substantially reduces the energy (electricity) required for lifting the water from wells/borewells. While reducing electricity consumption, DMI ultimately helps reducing carbon dioxide (CO2) emission, which is one of the important factors associated with climate change today. However, in spite of having many advantages over the method of flood irrigation, the coverage of area under drip method of irrigation is not appreciable in India except for a few states as of today. In this context, the seminar is arranged to discuss various pertinent issues relating to micro-irrigation in India.

Themes

Keeping in view the various developments in the area of micro-irrigation, the paper writers are invited to cover the following themes/issues:

- The present status of adoption of drip method of irrigation across different states in India.
- The impact of drip method of irrigation on water consumption and water use efficiency in different crops.
- The quantum of electricity saving and reduction in CO2 emission due to the adoption of drip irrigation in different crops.
- The productivity gains due to adoption of drip method of irrigation in different crops.
- The nexus between adoption of drip method of irrigation and groundwater use.
- Whether the investment on drip method of irrigation is economically viable or not under various scenarios; with and without subsidy as well as under different discount rates.
- The potential area available for drip method of irrigation and the potential gains from the same for India as a whole.
- Measures to increase the adoption of drip irrigation technology in India.

The last date for receiving the full papers with abstract (250 words) is **January 10, 2020.** The papers should be prepared in MS Word (Times New Roman, 12 font size for text, 14 for titles, and justified). The shortlisted papers for presentation will be informed to the authors by e-mail. Travel support (train fare) will be provided for selected papers. The papers can be sent to : **Dr. R. Suresh (saga42.suresh@gmail.com) / Dr. R. Manimohan (r_manimohan@yahoo.com)**

Book-Post

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